

Khaled Alam

Lead Full-Stack Engineer · PHP Core Contributor | PHP · Laravel · React/Next.js · TypeScript · AI/LLM

PERSONAL
INFORMATION

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LOCATION: Dubai, UAE / Alexandria, Egypt

WEBSITE: khaledalam.net · [blog](https://khaledalam.net/blog)

GITHUB: [@khaledalam](https://github.com/khaledalam)

LINKEDIN: in/khaledalam

PROFILE

Full-stack engineer who ships products end-to-end and works on the language underneath them. I authored a PHP RFC that passed the core vote 17-2-6 and ships in **PHP 8.6**, led a 7-engineer team whose app hit **#1 in the UAE App Store's Lifestyle chart** at launch, and delivered for Victoria's Secret PINK, STC, Arla Foods, Misk and Gillette. Former **Amazon** SDE intern and GenAI C++ contractor for **Cohere**. Ten years across PHP/Laravel, React/Next.js, TypeScript and production AI/LLM systems.

CURRENT
POSITION



PHP Core & Open Source Contributor, Open Source Community
Language engine, runtime and ecosystem contributions (details under Open Source below)

Nov 2025 – Present



WorldQuant University (WQU), Washington, D.C. (online)
Pursuing an M.Sc. in Financial Engineering

2025 – 2027 (Exp.)

EXPERIENCE



CanvaMagnet, Dubai, UAE
Founder & Owner

Feb 2025 – Feb 2026

- Built and ran a D2C e-commerce brand end-to-end (software, automation, operations), fulfilling **500+ orders**.
- Main vendor for **Gillette's** live activation at Dubai Festival City Mall.



Makyee, Dubai, UAE
Lead Full-Stack Engineer · PropTech

Apr 2024 – Mar 2025

- Delivered the React Native app from scratch for buying and selling Dubai property without agents; it went to **#1 in the UAE App Store's Lifestyle chart** at launch (Aug 2024).
- Led a team of **7 engineers**, on-site and remote, across backend, frontend, mobile and DevOps.
- Re-engineered a legacy Yii 1.1 platform into modular services with no loss of production stability; built REST APIs, integrations and CI/CD.



Contract engagements

Mar 2024 – Jun 2025

- Prepaire Labs**, Abu Dhabi (Apr – Jun 2025), Senior Frontend Engineer & API Integration Specialist: integrated Python/FastAPI services with **OpenAI GPT-4** and **LangChain** for an AI Digital Twin platform; built React tooling linking genomics and microbiome data.
- Cohere**, remote (Mar – Aug 2024), GenAI C++ Software Engineer & Problem Author: wrote C++ problems and reference solutions used to train and evaluate generative AI models.



9H Digital, Sliema, Malta (remote)
Senior Full-Stack Engineer (contract)

Nov 2022 – Mar 2024

- Delivered high-traffic event websites for **Misk** (Saudi Arabia).
- Reduced tech debt and improved performance across **100+ websites** through Composer and CI/CD.
- Launched a restaurant-management SaaS with subdomains, real-time tracking and Stripe.



Amplify Marketing Agency, Dubai, UAE
Senior Full-Stack Engineer

Feb 2021 – Oct 2022

- Led a small team delivering cross-platform solutions for **Victoria's Secret PINK**, **STC** and **Arla Foods**.
- Integrated Stripe payments and MongoDB across React Native and Shopify apps for production e-commerce.



Lead Liaison, Dallas, TX, USA
Software Engineer & AWS Cloud Solution Architect · **2020 Stand Out Engineer Award**

Feb 2020 – Feb 2021

- Architected microservice APIs with Symfony, React and Next.js on AWS, with CI/CD pipelines.
- Cut deployment time by **50%** through automation and better test coverage.



Amazon, Winnipeg, Canada
Software Development Engineer Intern

Nov 2019 – Jan 2020

	ABC Hosting Ltd , Warsaw, Poland (remote)	Jan 2016 – Aug 2019
	Full-Stack Developer - Core contributor to the CBA.pl, MintMe.com and CoinIMP.com web-hosting and crypto platforms. - Built distributed systems with Symfony, Vue.js and Docker, reducing production bugs by 25%.	

Earlier: Vola Solutions, Senior Full-Stack Engineer (Alexandria, 2020) · Kolega Kapital Indonesia, Mobile Engineer Intern (2019).

OPEN SOURCE
& PHP CORE



[1] PHP RFC: Allow Object Property Writes on Objects Referenced by Constants
Author and implementer · php-src, 2026 · **Accepted 17-2-6, shipped in PHP 8.6** [RFC] [commit] [write-up]
tl;dr: CONFIG->debug = true; is now legal for global and class constants. A constant's binding stays immutable, but the object it holds was always mutable. Taken through the internals list, a formal vote and code review.



[2] Fix GH-22683: Reflection __toString() should not warn on NAN
php-src #22694, Jul 2026 [PR] [write-up]
tl;dr: Found the root cause in the C source for a spurious NAN-coercion warning in Reflection and shipped the fix with tests.



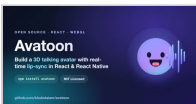
[3] New API: ReflectionConstant::inNamespace() and zend_class_use_internal_traits()
php-src #20902 (Feb 2026), #20976 (Jul 2026) [#20902] [#20976] · engine clean-ups [#20983] [#21085]
tl;dr: New public APIs for the Reflection extension and the Zend engine, plus removal of dead code and duplicate includes.

Also merged into: phpMyAdmin [#19564] · Symfony Demo, Arabic translation [#1142] · AWS SDK for PHP [#2078].
Submitted: MySQL Server fix for Bug #119727, temporal BETWEEN ... AND NULL results, accepted into Oracle's review queue [PR].

PROJECTS



[4] Mini Command: a free online real-time strategy game
TypeScript, Phaser, Cloudflare Workers & Durable Objects, 2026 [play] [write-up]
tl;dr: A 1v1 real-time strategy game that runs in the browser, with live online multiplayer.



[5] Avatoon: 3D talking avatars with lip-sync for React
React, React Native, Three Fiber · open source, 2026 [code] [demo]
tl;dr: A drop-in component that animates a 3D avatar's mouth and head in sync with speech, for web and mobile.

HONORS &
TEACHING

Stand Out Engineer Award , Lead Liaison	2020
Reported a crash in Ubuntu's pyecm while factoring RSA-260, confirmed by maintainers (Launchpad #1899312)	2020
1st Place , Catalysts Coding Contest	2018
Top 15 in Egypt, ACM ICPC Egyptian Collegiate Programming Contest (ECPC)	2018
C++ instructor, ICPC Mansoura University chapter	2016 – 2019

EDUCATION

WorldQuant University (WQU) , M.Sc. Financial Engineering	2025 – 2027 (Exp.)
Faculty of Computers and Information, Mansoura , B.Sc. Computer Science	2015 – 2019

SKILLS

Backend	PHP (incl. C internals), Laravel, Symfony, Yii, WordPress, Magento, Python, FastAPI, REST API design
Frontend & Mobile	React, Next.js, TypeScript, React Native, Tailwind, HTML/CSS/SCSS
AI & Data	LLM APIs, OpenAI, LangChain, Ollama, RAG, embeddings, Pandas, Neo4j
Architecture	SaaS, multi-tenant systems, microservices, legacy modernisation, performance & reliability
Cloud & DevOps	AWS, Cloudflare Workers, Docker, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Linux, Nginx
Databases	MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB, Neo4j

CERTIFICATIONS
& LANGUAGES

Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) and Certified Scrum Developer (CSD), Scrum Alliance, 2022 · GDPR Awareness, ICE Malta, 2023
Arabic (native) · English (fluent) · French (basic)